



Universidad  
de Concepción

FACULTAD DE  
CIENCIAS  
BIOLÓGICAS  
Universidad de Concepción

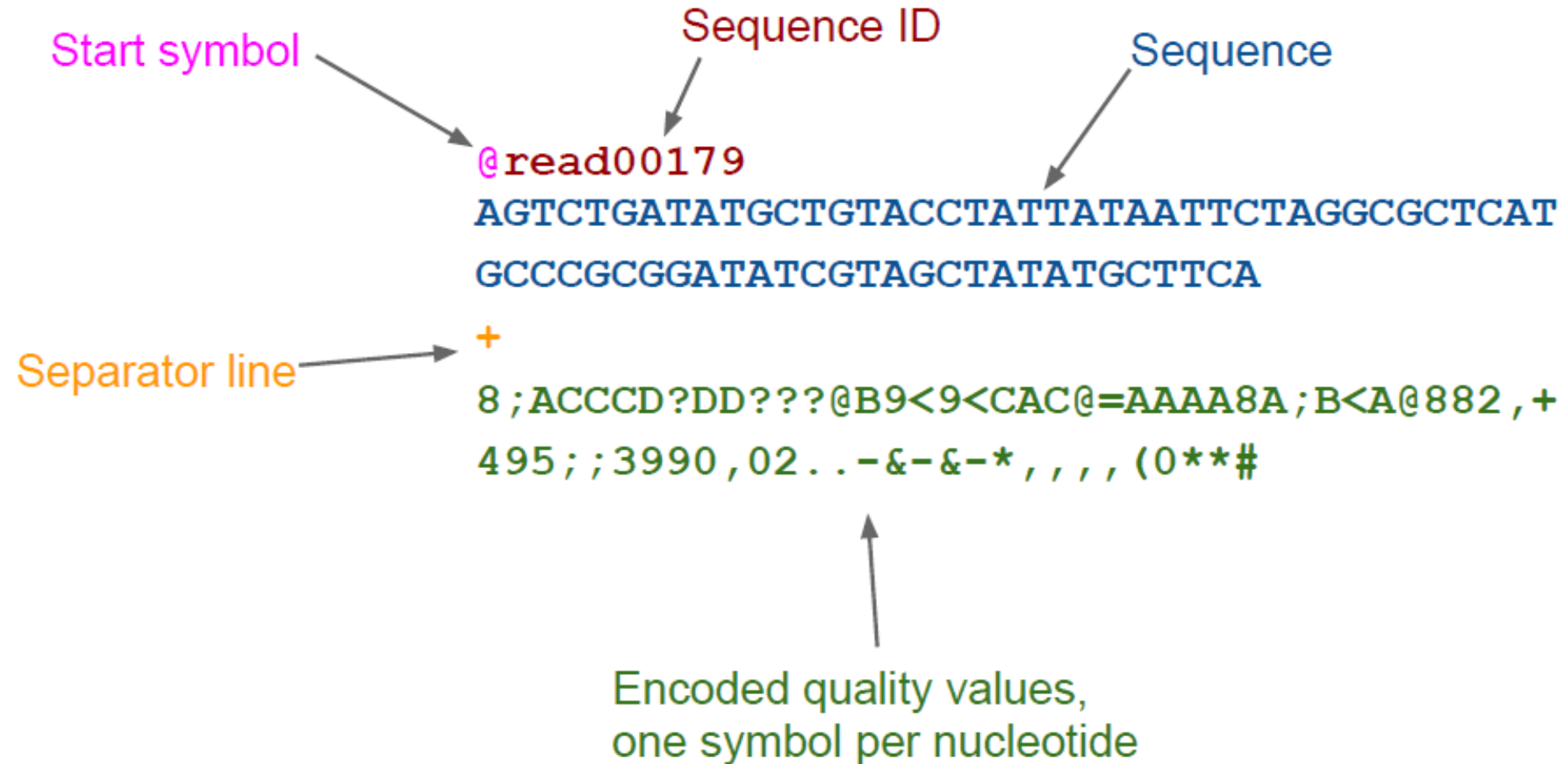


## Quality Control



# Formato FASTQ

Is an extension of the FASTA format carrying quality values associated with each base



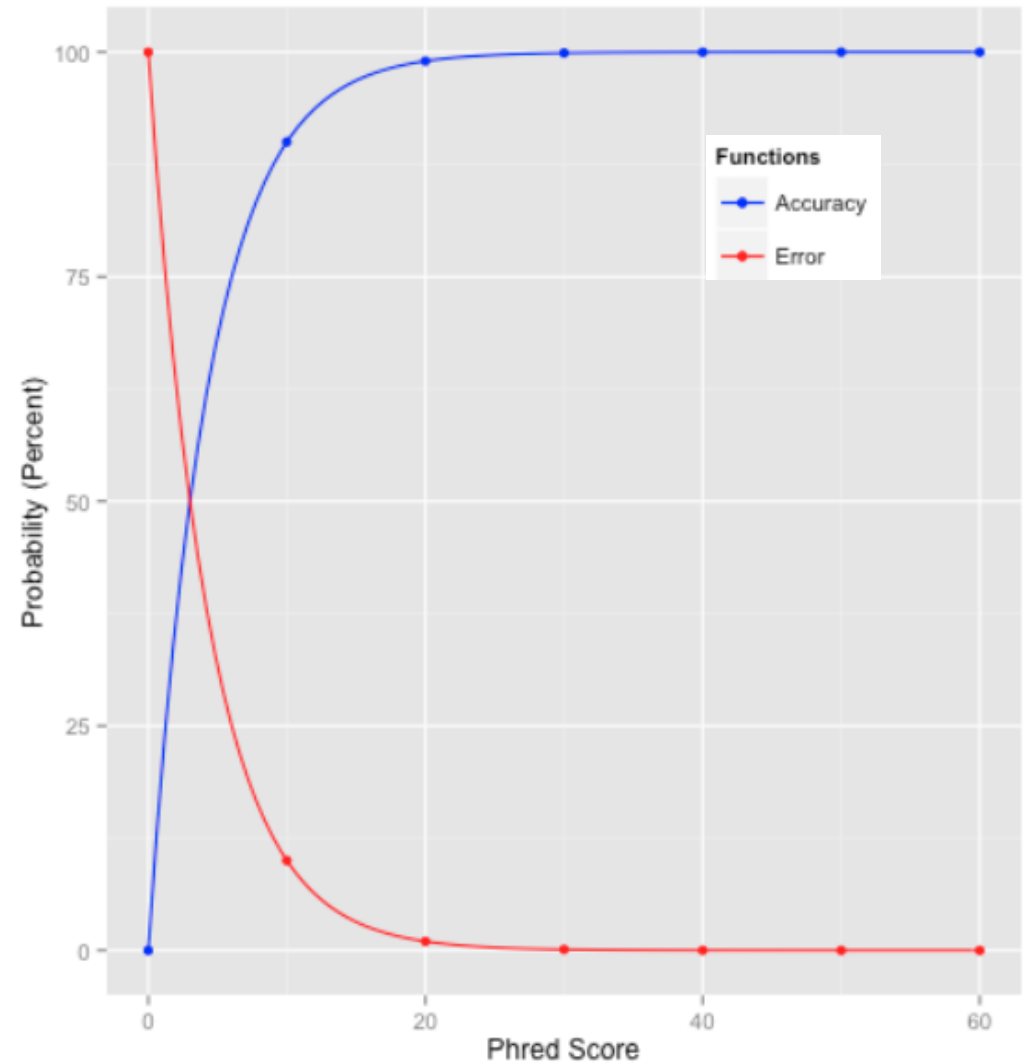
# Quality Value are expressed by phred score

Sequencing quality scores measure the probability that a base is called incorrectly. With sequencing by synthesis (SBS) technology, each base in a read is assigned with a quality score by a phred algorithm.

The sequencing quality score of a given base,  $Q$ , is defined by the following equation:

$$Q = -10\log_{10}(e)$$

where  $e$  is the estimated probability of the base call being wrong.



# How quality value are generated

Illumina quality scores are calculated for each base call in a **two-step** process:

1. Quality predictor values are **observable properties of clusters** from which base calls are extracted.
  - a) **intensity profiles**
  - b) **signal-to-noise ratios**
2. A **quality model**, also known as a **quality table or Q-table**, lists combinations of **quality predictor values** and relates them to corresponding quality scores.

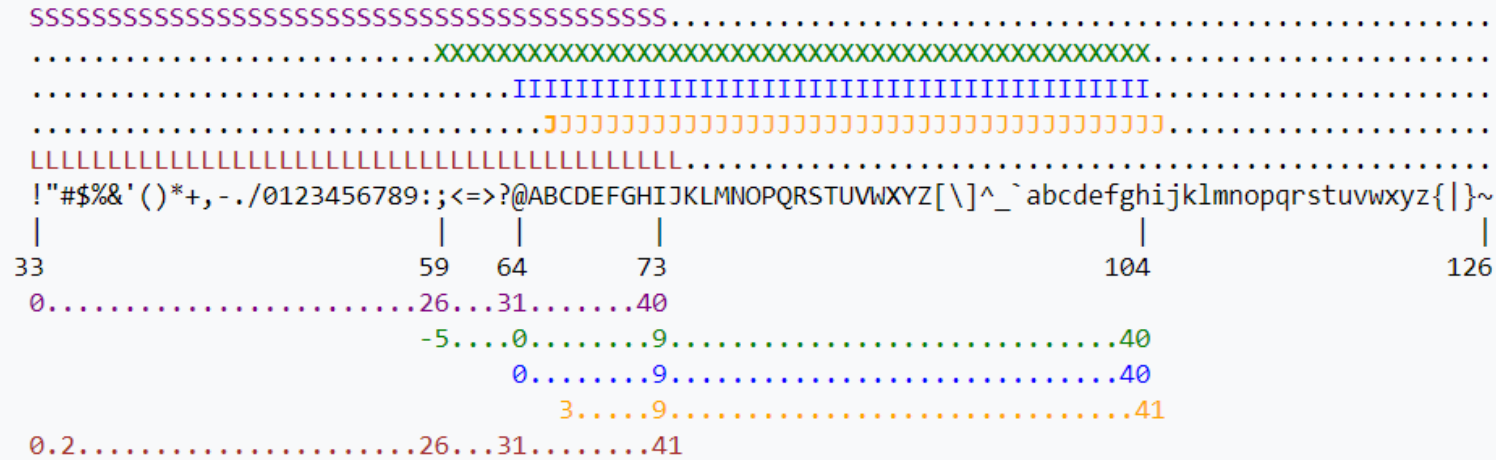
Table 1: Q-Scores and Error Probabilities

| Quality Score | Error Probability    |
|---------------|----------------------|
| Q40           | 0.0001 (1 in 10,000) |
| Q30           | 0.001 (1 in 1,000)   |
| Q20           | 0.01 (1 in 100)      |
| Q10           | 0.1 (1 in 10)        |

## Quality value code

The quality values are coded on letters and symbols

The coding system is the ASCII (American Standard Code for Information Interchange)

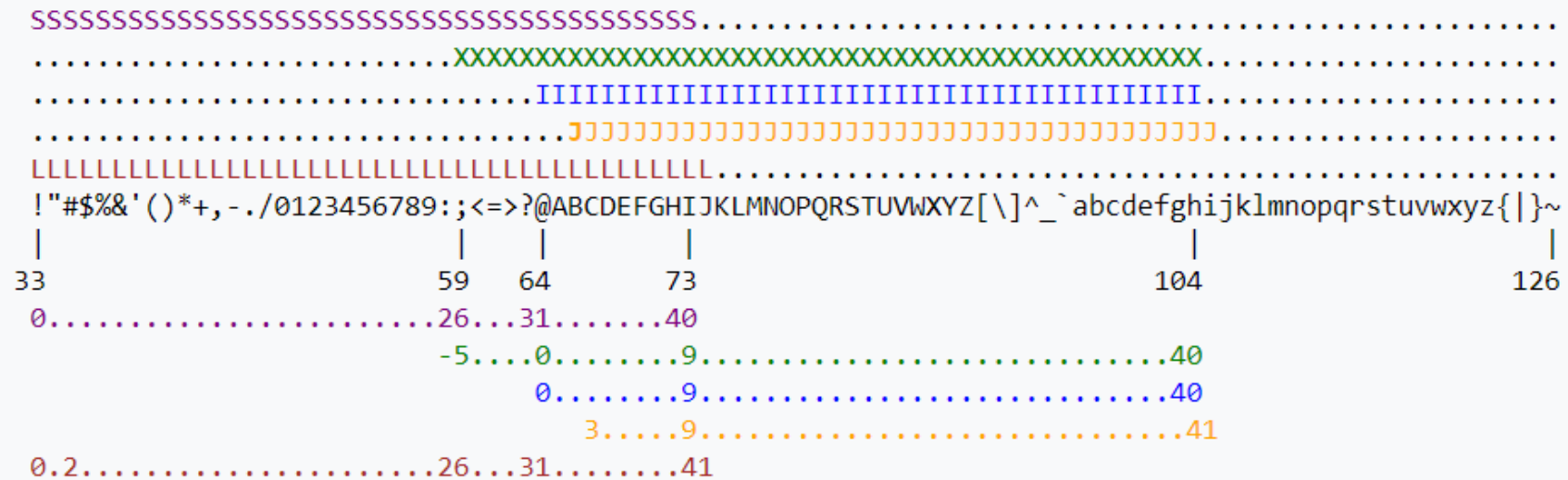


S - Sanger Phred+33, raw reads typically (0, 40)  
X - Solexa Solexa+64, raw reads typically (-5, 40)  
I - Illumina 1.3+ Phred+64, raw reads typically (0, 40)  
J - Illumina 1.5+ Phred+64, raw reads typically (3, 41)  
with 0=unused, 1=unused, 2=Read Segment Quality Control Indicator (bold)  
(Note: See discussion above).  
L - Illumina 1.8+ Phred+33, raw reads typically (0, 41)

|                                             |  |       |  |     |  |      |  |           |  |
|---------------------------------------------|--|-------|--|-----|--|------|--|-----------|--|
| !"#\$%&'()*+,-./0123456789:;<=>?@ABCDEFGHIJ |  |       |  |     |  |      |  |           |  |
|                                             |  |       |  |     |  |      |  |           |  |
| Q0                                          |  | Q10   |  | Q20 |  | Q30  |  | Q40       |  |
| bad                                         |  | maybe |  | ok  |  | good |  | excellent |  |

# Quality value exercise

```
@SRR001666.1 071112_SLXA-EAS1_s_7:5:1:817:345 length=72
GGGTGATGGCCGCTGCCGATGGCGTCAAATCCCACCAAGTTACCCTTAACAACCTTAAGGGTTTTCAAATAGA
+SRR001666.1 071112_SLXA-EAS1_s_7:5:1:817:345 length=72
IIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIII9IG9ICIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIIDIIIIIII>IIIIII/
```



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(Note: See discussion above).  
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# Additional quality issues on sequencing data

The sequences might contain errors such as:

- > **“Trash” Reads** (Uncharacterized errors)
- > **Duplicated Reads** (Low complexity libraries and PCR duplicates)
- > **Reading into the adapters** (short fragments in comparison with read length)
- > **Error Indel** (Deletion or insertion of a base during sequencing )
- > **Undetermined Base** (base calling base was uncertain and it is replaced by an N)
- > **Substitution errors** (wrong base calling base)

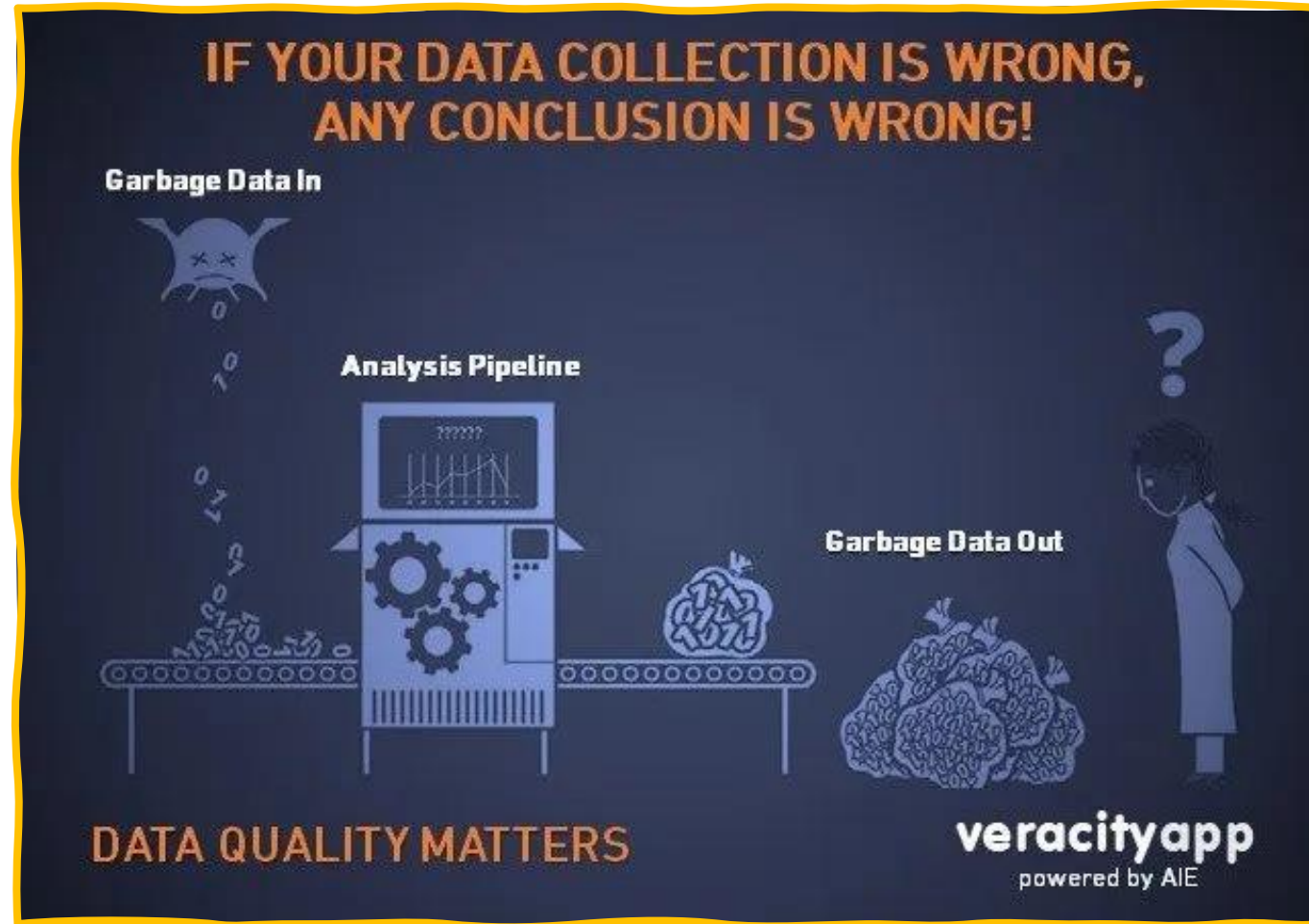
Rare



Common

# How data quality impacts on my results?

## The GIGO (GARBAGE IN — GARBAGE OUT) PARADIGM



To avoid starting with bad quality data, we perform a quality control analysis



# Quality analysis and global statistics

Due to different source errors that might be present in our sequences, it is crucial to perform a quality check **BEFORE** we start the analysis.

The gold standard program to do quality checks is **FASTQC**



Babraham Bioinformatics

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## FastQC

|                              |                                                                                                                            |
|------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Function                     | A quality control tool for high throughput sequence data.                                                                  |
| Language                     | Java                                                                                                                       |
| Requirements                 | A <a href="#">suitable Java Runtime Environment</a><br>The <a href="#">Picard</a> BAM/SAM Libraries (included in download) |
| Code Maturity                | Stable. Mature code, but feedback is appreciated.                                                                          |
| Code Released                | Yes, under <a href="#">GPL v3 or later</a> .                                                                               |
| Initial Contact              | <a href="#">Simon Andrews</a>                                                                                              |
| <a href="#">Download Now</a> |                                                                                                                            |

<https://www.bioinformatics.babraham.ac.uk/projects/fastqc/>

# FASTQC Quality analysis

- > **Global statistics** (Number of sequences, read length, %GC )
- > **Phred quality score** (Per base and global Q-score)
- > **%GC** (most important for genome assembly)
- > **Undetermined Base** (% N bases along the reads)
- > **Phred quality score** (Per base and global Q-score)
- > **Distribution of read length**
- > **Read Duplication**
- > **Overrepresented sequences**
- > **Adapter Content**

# FASTQC Report

## Good Quality Run

### Summary

- ✓ [Basic Statistics](#)
- ✓ [Per base sequence quality](#)
- ✓ [Per tile sequence quality](#)
- ✓ [Per sequence quality scores](#)
- ✓ [Per base sequence content](#)
- ✓ [Per sequence GC content](#)
- ✓ [Per base N content](#)
- ✓ [Sequence Length Distribution](#)
- ✓ [Sequence Duplication Levels](#)
- ✓ [Overrepresented sequences](#)
- ✓ [Adapter Content](#)



OK



warning



Fail

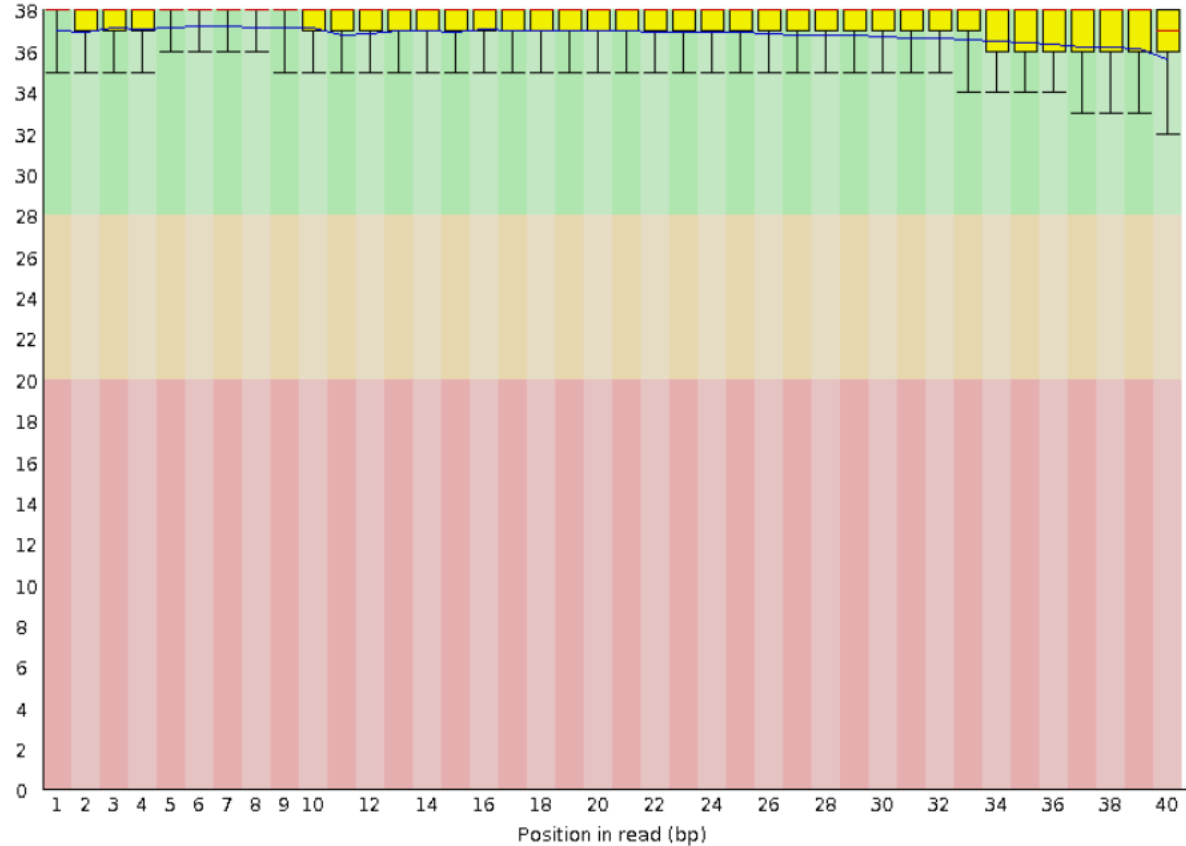
## Bad Quality Run

### Summary

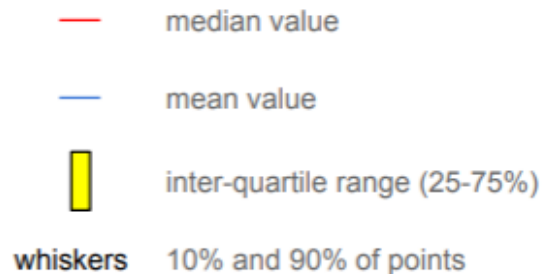
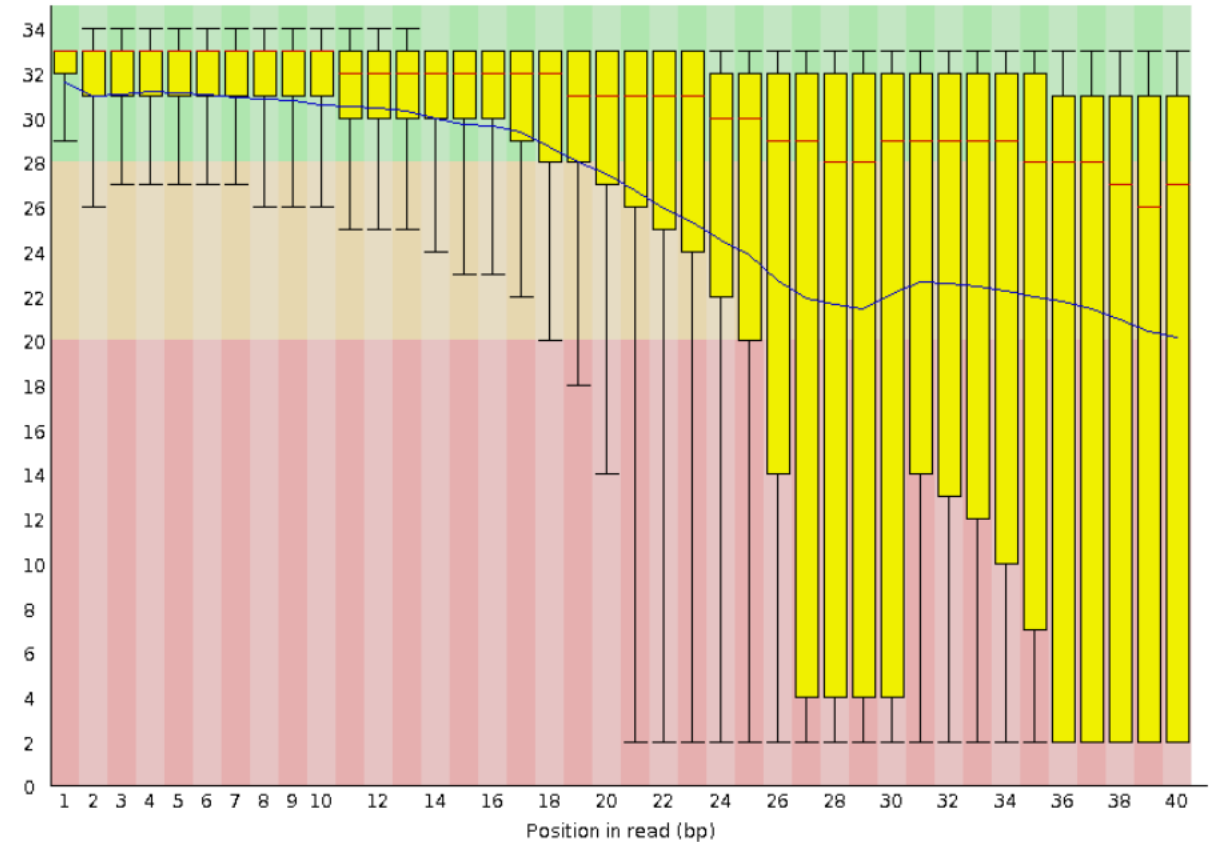
- ✓ [Basic Statistics](#)
- ✗ [Per base sequence quality](#)
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- ! [Per sequence GC content](#)
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- ✓ [Sequence Length Distribution](#)
- ! [Sequence Duplication Levels](#)
- ! [Overrepresented sequences](#)
- ✓ [Adapter Content](#)

# Per Base quality

## Good Quality Run



## Bad Quality Run

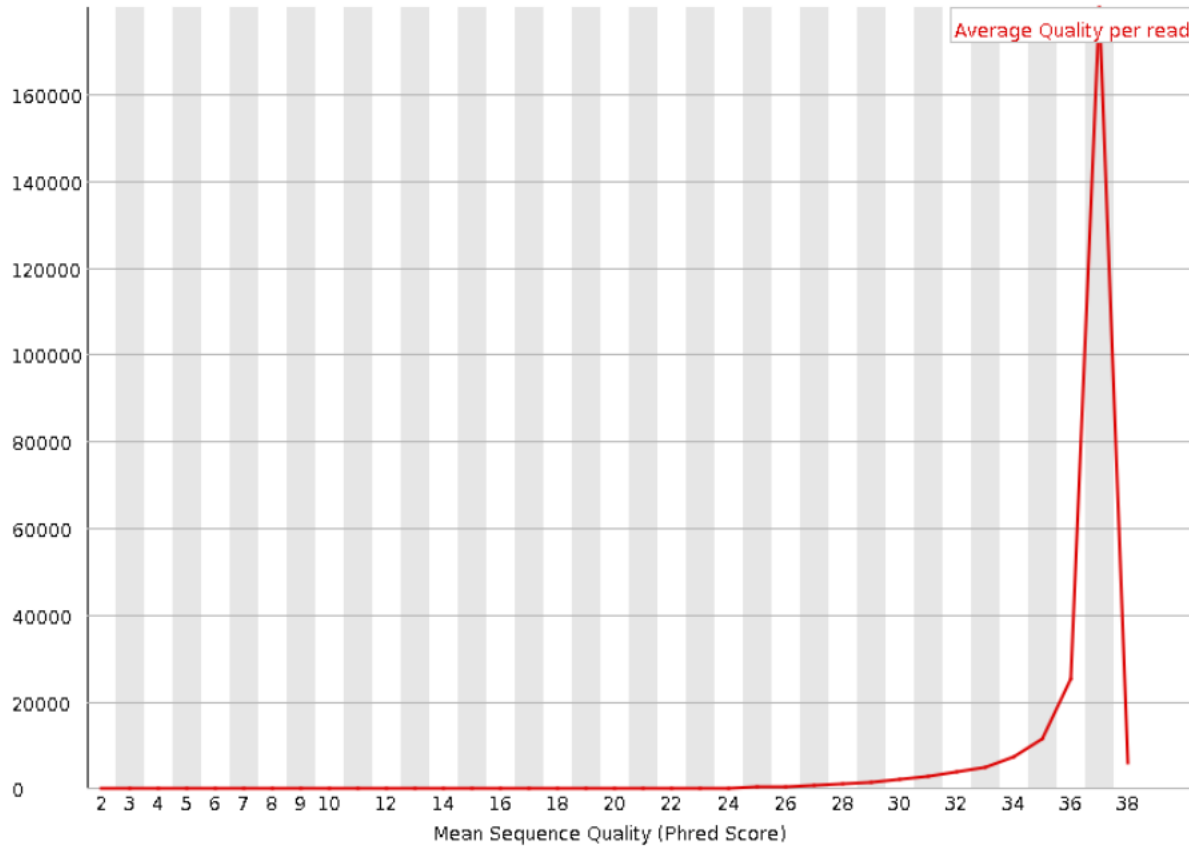


## How can I Improve?:

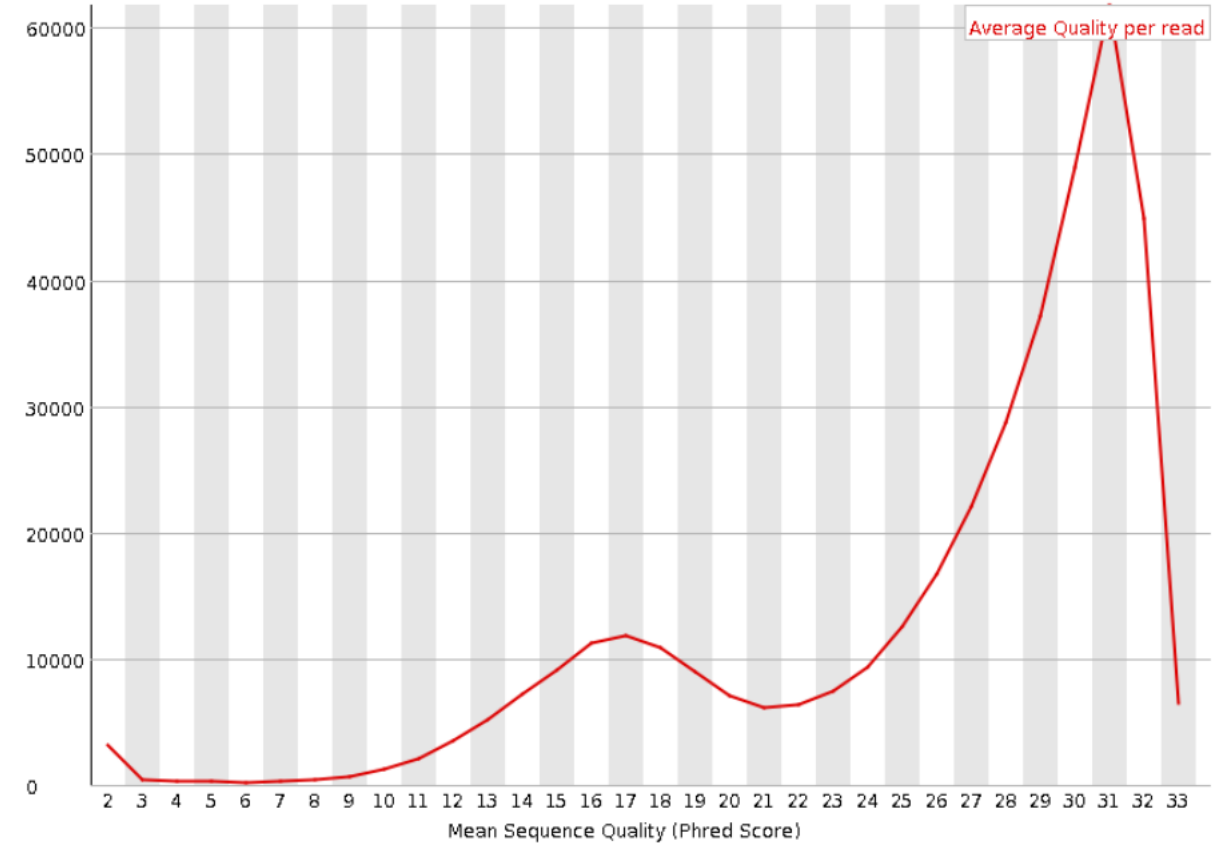
Trim bad quality bases from 3' (<20-25 Phred score)  
Do not keep reads shorter than 35bp

# Per sequence quality value

## Good Quality Run



## Bad Quality Run

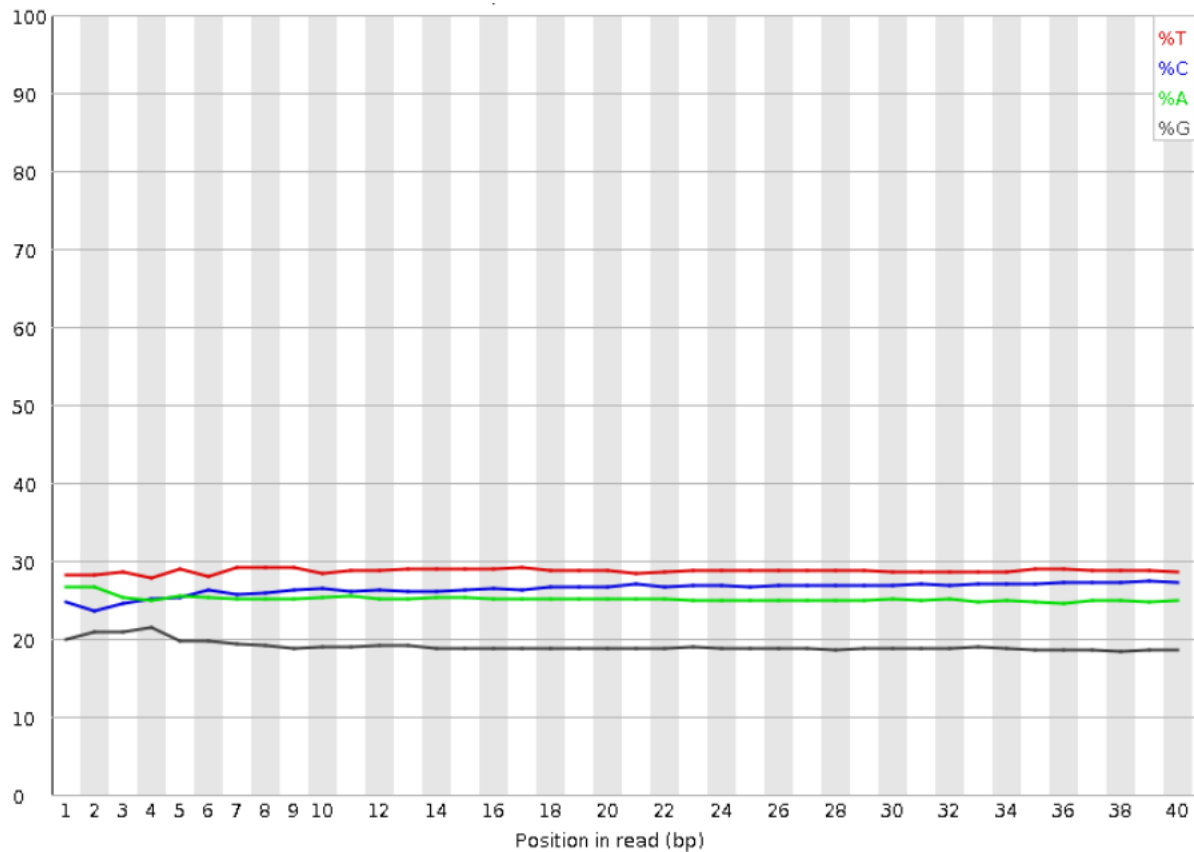


**How can I Improve?:**

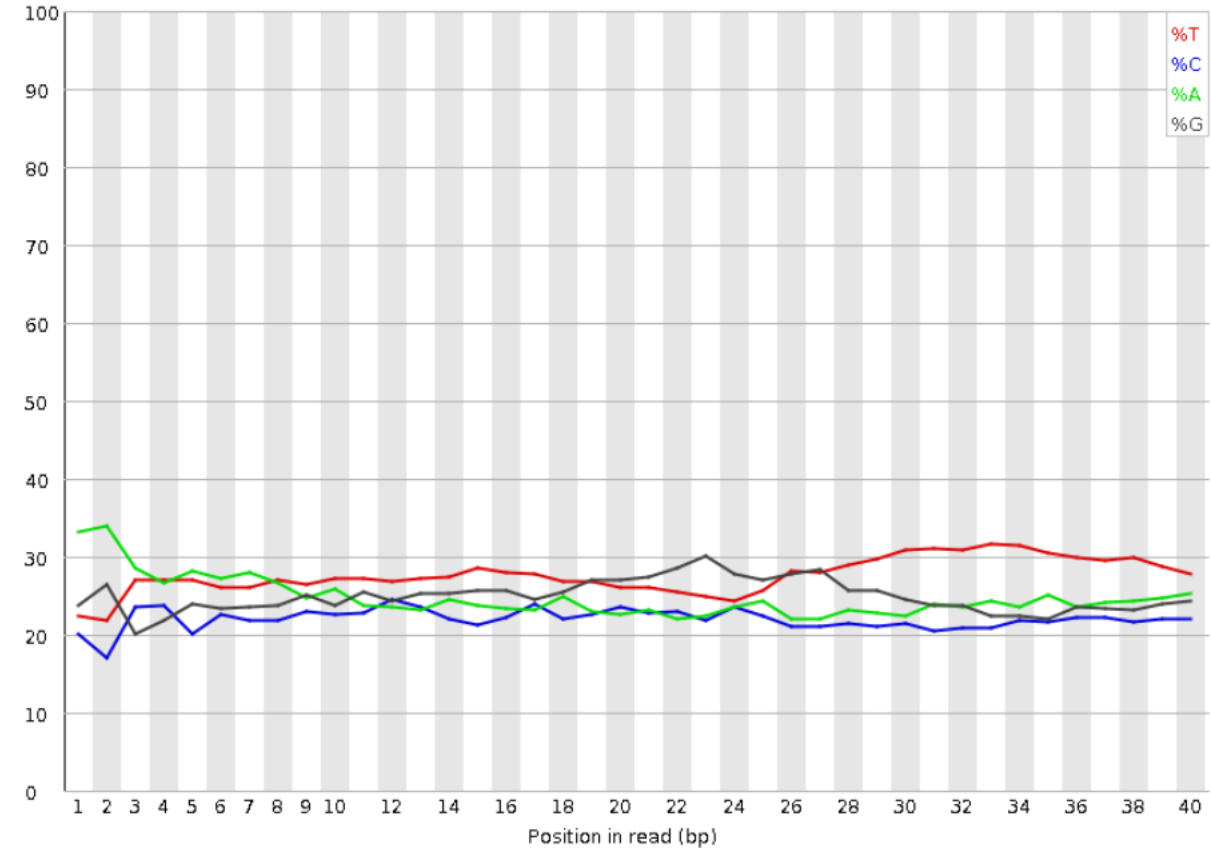
Remove reads with average phred score smaller than 20

# Base content

## Good Quality Run



## Bad Quality Run

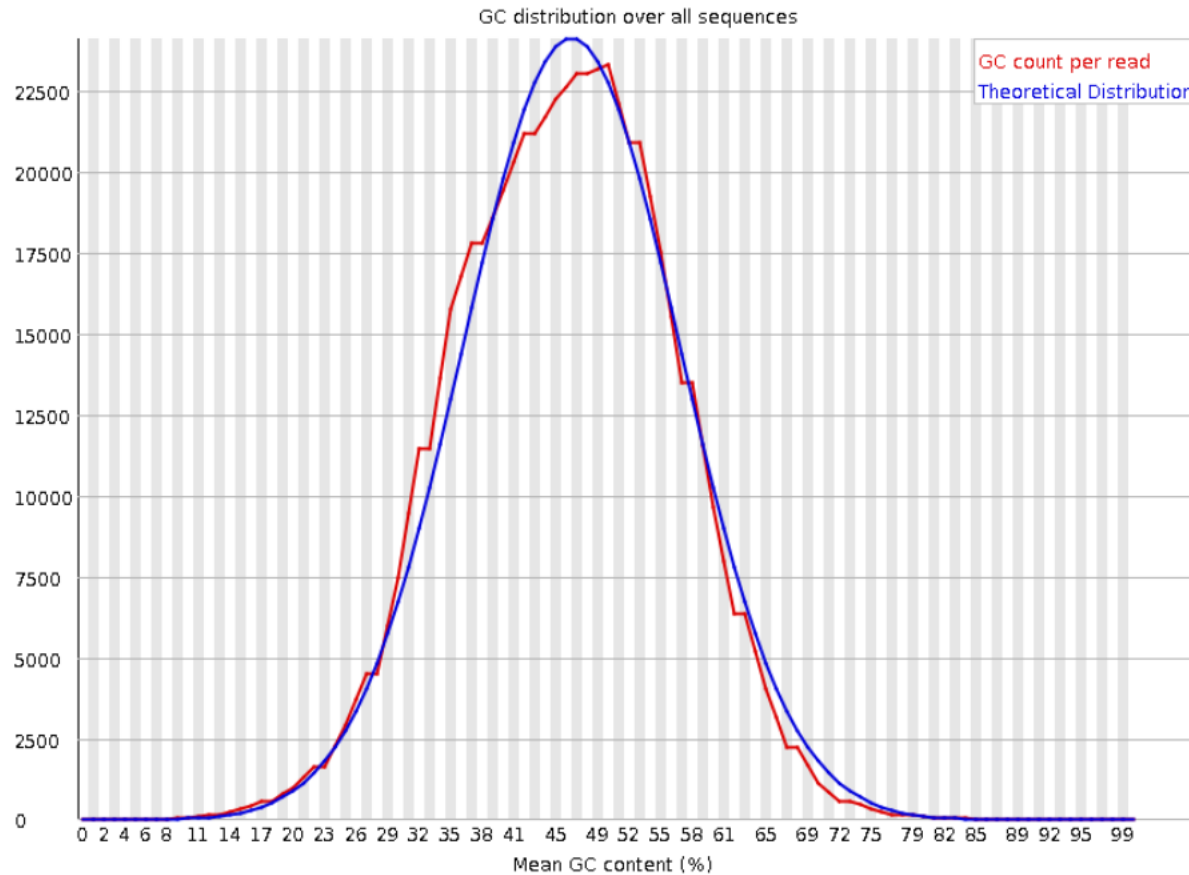


## How can I Improve?:

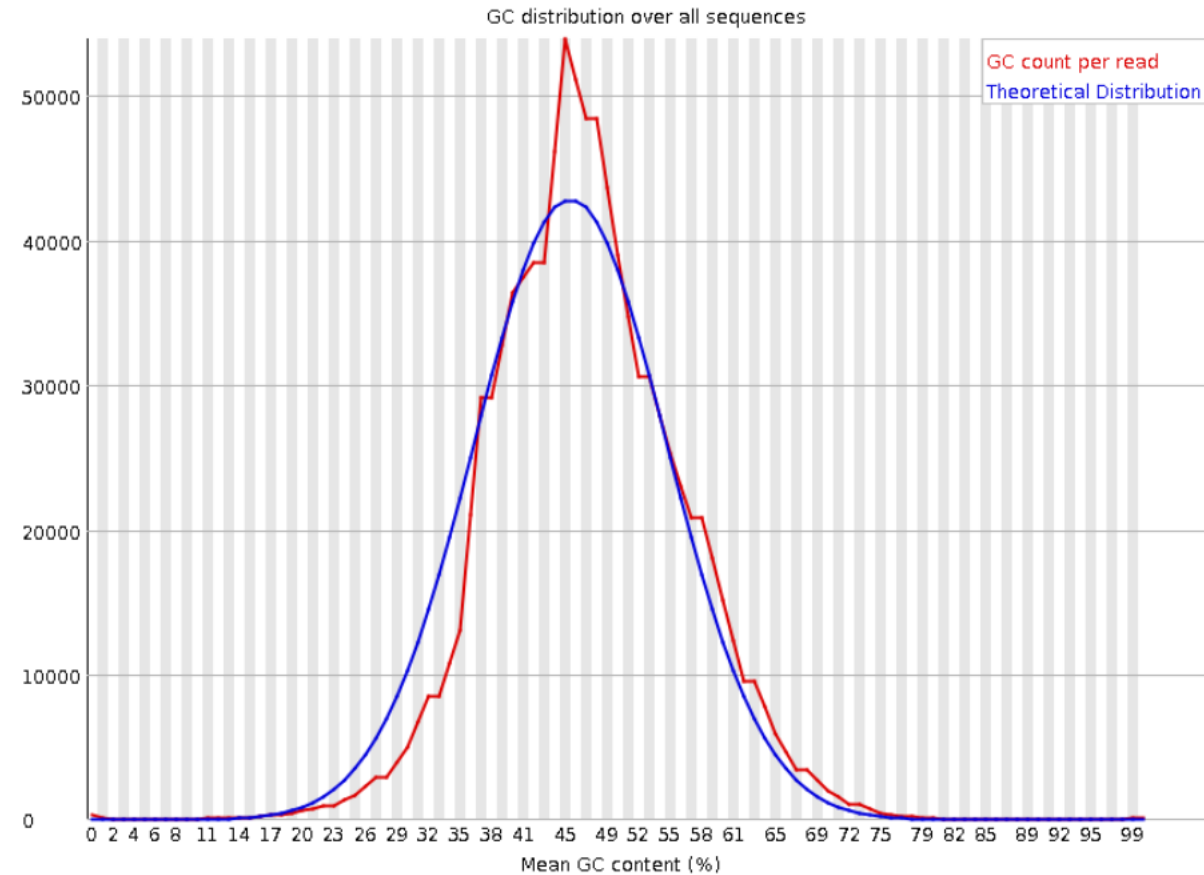
If base bias is present at the ends of the read, we can cut bases from the end and start of the read.

# GC content

## Good Quality Run



## Bad Quality Run

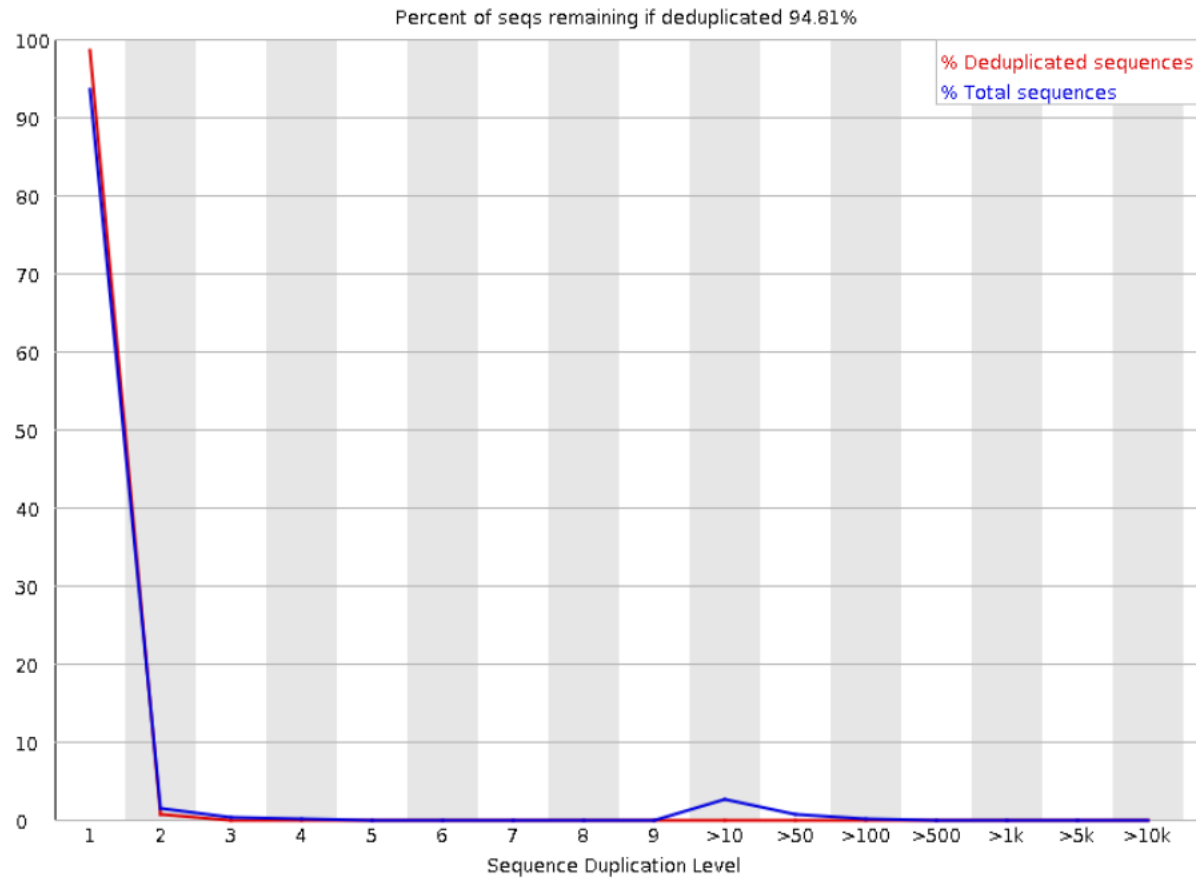


## How can I Improve?:

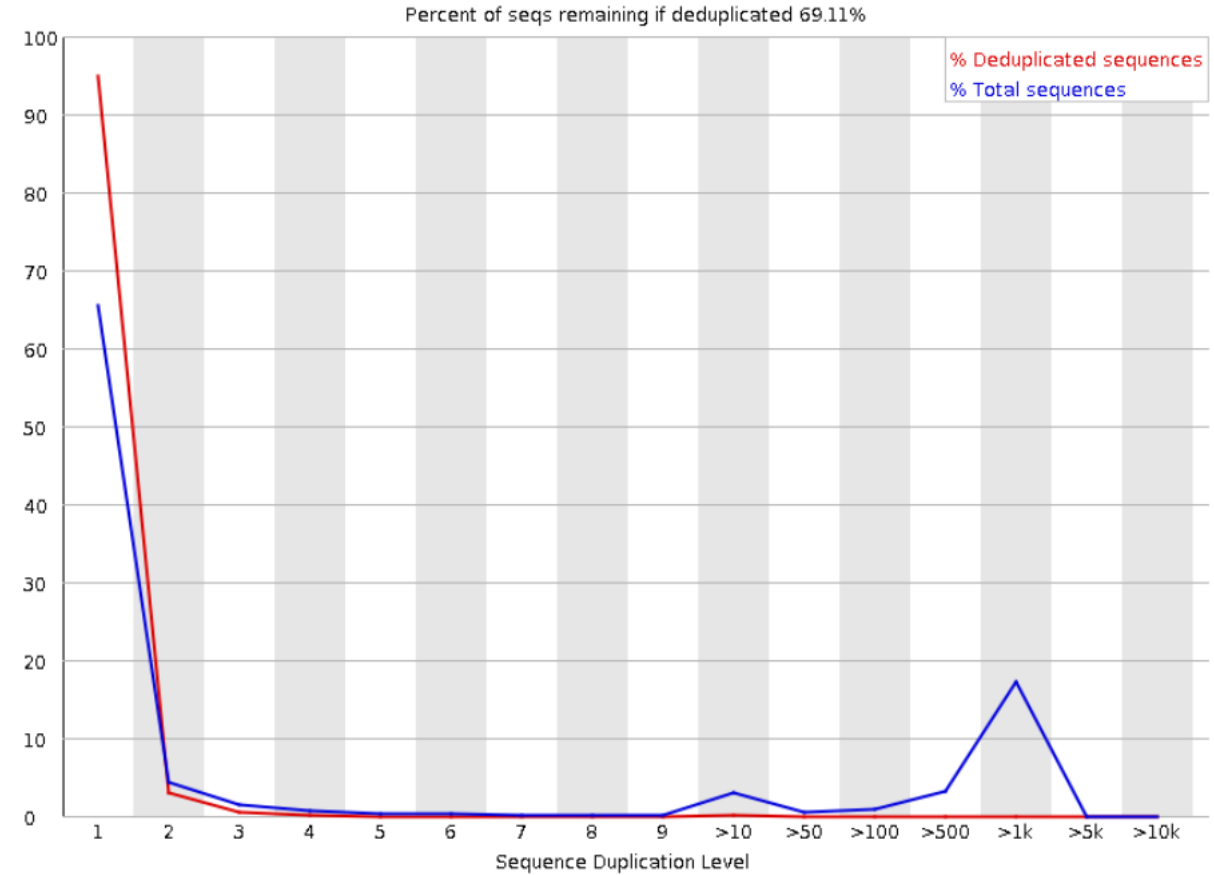
In genomics, two peaks might indicate contamination with another organism.  
In transcriptomics, this value varies with the composition of the transcriptome

# Read duplication

## Good Quality Run



## Bad Quality Run



## How can I Improve?:

I don't do much at this point, I assess read duplication after alignment



# Overrepresented sequences (more than 0,1% of the total)

Good Quality Run

Bad Quality Run

## ! Overrepresented sequences

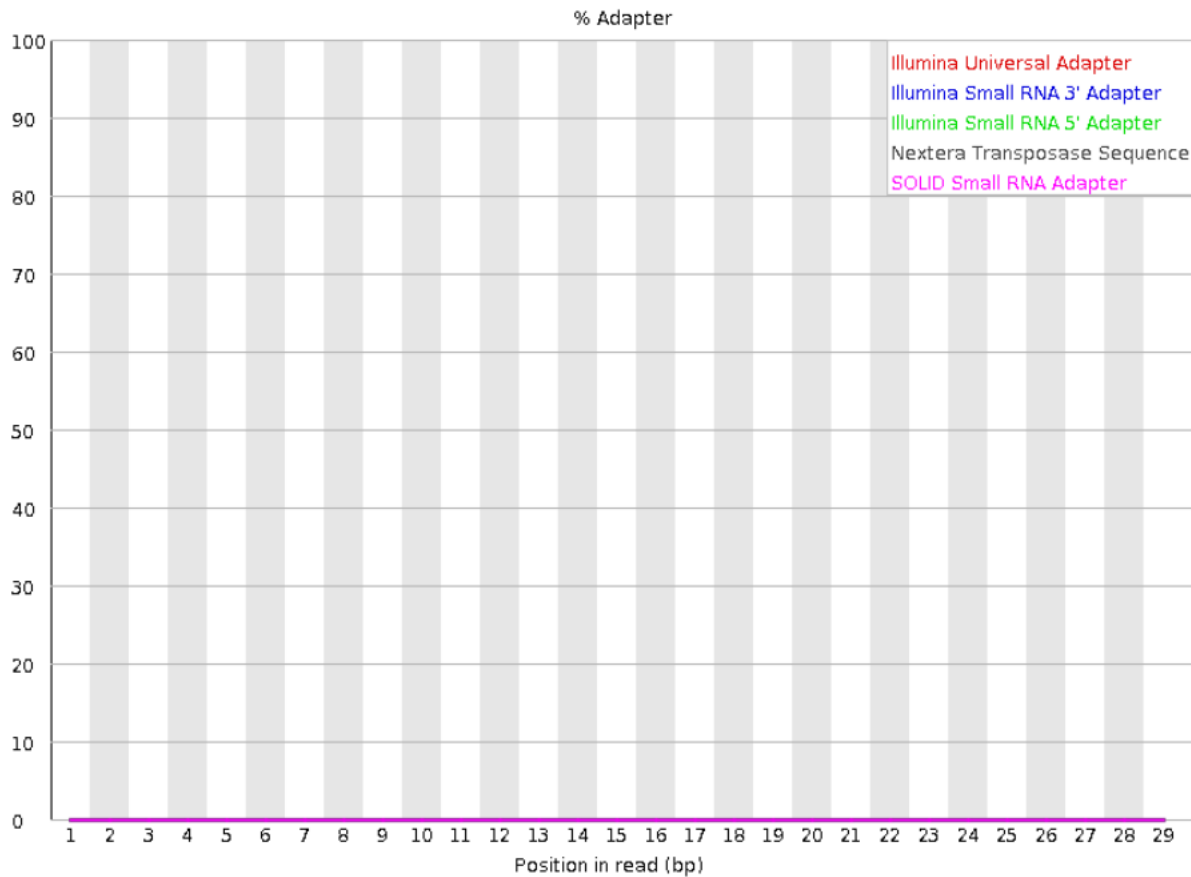
| Sequence                                | Count | Percentage          | Possible Source |
|-----------------------------------------|-------|---------------------|-----------------|
| AGAGTTTATCGCTTCCATGACGCAGAAGTTAACTTTC   | 2065  | 0.5224039181558763  | No Hit          |
| GATTGGCGTATCCAACCTGCAGAGTTTATCGCTTCCATG | 2047  | 0.5178502762542754  | No Hit          |
| ATTGGCGTATCCAACCTGCAGAGTTTATCGCTTCCATGA | 2014  | 0.5095019327680071  | No Hit          |
| CGATAAAATGATTGGCGTATCCAACCTGCAGAGTTTAT  | 1913  | 0.4839509420979134  | No Hit          |
| GTATCCAACCTGCAGAGTTTATCGCTTCCATGACGCAGA | 1879  | 0.4753496185060066  | No Hit          |
| AAAAATGATTGGCGTATCCAACCTGCAGAGTTTATCGCT | 1846  | 0.4670012750197325  | No Hit          |
| TGATTGGCGTATCCAACCTGCAGAGTTTATCGCTTCCAT | 1841  | 0.46573637449150995 | No Hit          |
| AACCTGCAGAGTTTATCGCTTCCATGACGCAGAAGTTAA | 1836  | 0.46447147396328753 | No Hit          |
| GATAAAATGATTGGCGTATCCAACCTGCAGAGTTTATC  | 1831  | 0.4632065734350651  | No Hit          |
| AAATGATTGGCGTATCCAACCTGCAGAGTTTATCGCTTC | 1779  | 0.45005160794155147 | No Hit          |
| ATGATTGGCGTATCCAACCTGCAGAGTTTATCGCTTCCA | 1779  | 0.45005160794155147 | No Hit          |

## How can I Improve?:

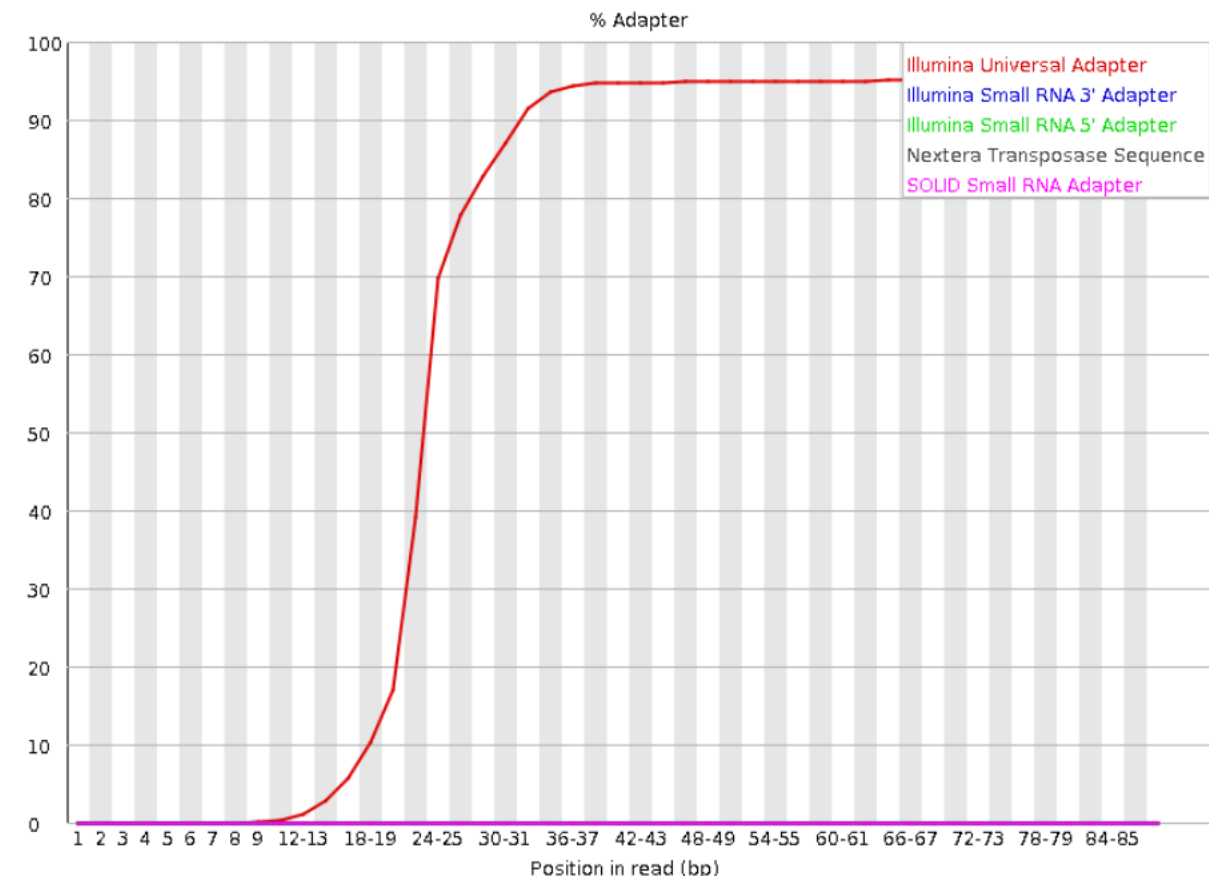
RNA-seq will tend to have overrepresented sequences coming from highly expressed genes  
Just blast the sequences listed on the report to be such makes sense with your sample,  
otherwise it might be contamination

# Adapter Content

## Good Quality Run



## Bad Quality Run



**How can I Improve?:**

Clip adapter from your sequences using the pre-processing programs :D